



CPO1/CWO Corp NEWSLETTER-

-Sep 2025-



MESSAGE FROM THE CANADIAN FORCES CHIEF WARRANT OFFICER

In an increasingly Volatile, Unpredictable, Complex, and Ambiguous (VUCA) world, the need for readiness, adaptability, and professionalism has never been greater. Global tensions, emerging threats, and shifting alliances demand that we remain vigilant and prepared—both at home and abroad. The Canadian Armed Forces continues to play a critical role in deterrence, defense, and support, working alongside our allies to maintain stability while protecting our national interests.

As leaders, we must uphold the fundamentals: operational excellence, ethical leadership, and the unwavering commitment to our people's well-being. Our strength lies in leading by example, training with purpose, and supporting one another through the challenges ahead. Whether deployed or at home station, each of you plays a vital role in safeguarding Canada's security.

ETHICAL OVERSIGHT IN THE CANADIAN ARMED FORCES: STRENGTHENING ACCOUNTABILITY AND FAIRNESS

The Canadian Armed Forces (CAF) defines itself as a profession of arms, grounded in principles of trust, integrity, and accountability. Like other professions that hold their members to high ethical standards, such as law, medicine, and policing, the CAF has established a code of ethics and various internal mechanisms to address misconduct. However, one critical question remains: Does the CAF have the right tools to ensure fairness when ethical breaches are alleged?

While the CAF has systems in place to uphold ethical conduct, there is currently no independent investigative body dedicated to handling ethical allegations. This raises an important concern: Can a system be truly fair if the authority responsible for investigating ethical breaches is the same one responsible for enforcing them?

Even more concerning is that those who are wrongfully accused of misconduct or harassment have no dedicated recourse to clear their names. The absence of such tools creates immense distress, frustration, and lasting reputational harm, leaving many with a lack of trust in a system that is supposed to be fair. If the CAF truly values integrity and justice, then procedural fairness must be applied not only to those making allegations but also to those facing them.

The Role of Ethical Oversight in a Profession

A profession is more than a job, it is an institution defined by specialized knowledge, a commitment to service, and a system of self-regulation. Professions like law and medicine operate under independent regulatory bodies that ensure fair and impartial oversight of ethical breaches. These bodies serve two purposes: they reinforce accountability by ensuring that ethical violations are addressed appropriately, and they protect the rights of individuals by ensuring that accusations are evaluated based on evidence rather than

perception or personal bias.

The CAF, as a profession of arms, already holds its members to high ethical standards. Yet, unlike other professions, it lacks an independent mechanism to investigate allegations of ethical misconduct in a way that is separate from the Chain of Command.



The Challenge: Fairness and the Risk of Perception-Based Allegations

The CAF has several internal processes for handling allegations, including administrative reviews, the Defence Ethics Programme (DEP), and grievance systems. However, these processes are embedded within the Chain of Command, creating potential conflicts of interest.

One of the most pressing concerns is the role of perception in ethical allegations. Perception matters in leadership and professional conduct, but should perception alone be enough to determine a person's professional future? There have been cases where allega-

tions, though unproven, have resulted in career consequences simply because the perception of wrongdoing was enough to warrant action.

Without an independent investigative body, individuals facing allegations often have no external avenue to challenge decisions or clear their names.

This can create significant stress and uncertainty, especially when no formal wrongdoing has been established. The 2021 Fish Report and the 2022 Arbour Report highlighted similar concerns, noting that military investigations should, in some cases, be transferred to independent civilian authorities to ensure fairness and objectivity. While these reports focused largely on misconduct cases, their findings underscore a broader need for independent oversight in ethical matters.

The Absence of Recourse for the Wrongfully Accused

A fundamental flaw in the current system is the lack of any structured recourse for those who are falsely



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accused of misconduct or harassment. While there are mechanisms to file complaints, there is no dedicated process for individuals to formally challenge unfounded accusations, nor is there a system to restore the reputation of those who have been wrongly targeted.

This gap has significant consequences. False accusations can lead to emotional and psychological distress, including anxiety, depression, and a profound sense of injustice. Professionally, even if an accusation is ultimately dismissed, the stain on one's career can have lasting repercussions. When members see colleagues struggle against unproven allegations with no support, it weakens confidence in leadership and the institution as a whole.

If the CAF is to maintain trust in its ethical system, it must ensure that all members, both complainants and the accused, have access to procedural fairness.

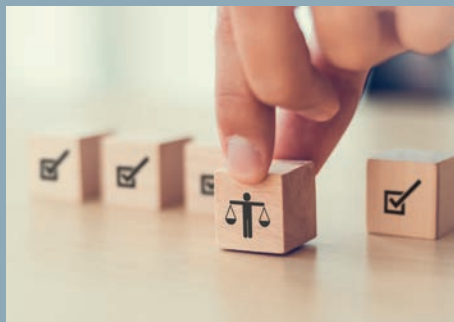
The Case for an Independent Investigative Body

The establishment of an independent ethical investigative body could provide an impartial mechanism to examine allegations, protect procedural fairness, and reinforce accountability.

An independent investigative body would ensure impartiality and fairness by conducting investigations outside the Chain of Command, reducing the risk of bias. Members accused of ethical breaches would have access to a neutral, fact-based review process, rather than relying on internal systems that may be influenced by rank, relationships, or institutional pressures.

Such a body would protect both complainants and the accused by ensuring that all voices are heard and that investigations are conducted based on evidence rather than perception. This would help promote confidence in the process and prevent decisions from being made based on incomplete information or institutional pressures. Establishing an independent body would

also strengthen confidence in military justice. Trust in leadership grows when people believe that justice is applied fairly and consistently. External oversight could reduce skepticism about internal investigations and reinforce ethical integrity across the CAF.



Furthermore, a fair investigative process would reduce the risk of professional or personal harm. False or unproven allegations can have lasting career and reputational consequences. By providing individuals with a structured and independent avenue to challenge claims, the CAF could demonstrate its commitment to fairness, justice, and due process.

Considerations and Challenges

Implementing an independent investigative body would require careful planning. Key considerations include determining whether it would be fully external or a hybrid model with military and civilian oversight. It would also be crucial to ensure that investigations remain timely, as lengthy processes could create further uncertainty and stress for those involved. Additionally, resource allocation would need to be addressed,

as such a body would require funding and trained personnel with expertise in military ethics and justice.

While these challenges are significant, the long-term benefits; greater trust, fairness, and professionalism, would outweigh the difficulties of implementation.

Looking Ahead: Strengthening the Profession of Arms

The CAF has taken steps to modernize its approach to ethics and accountability, but a truly fair system must ensure that ethical allegations are handled with the same level of professionalism and impartiality as any other serious matter. An independent investigative body could provide a balanced, fair, and transparent mechanism for addressing ethical concerns. It would reinforce the CAF's commitment to integrity and justice while ensuring that military members have the tools to challenge allegations fairly and protect their professional reputations.

As the CAF continues to evolve, the question is no longer whether accountability matters, but how it can be strengthened to ensure fairness for all.

References

- Fish, M. (2021). *Report of the Third Independent Review of the National Defence Act*.
- Arbour, L. (2022). *Independent External Comprehensive Review into Sexual Misconduct and Sexual Harassment in the Department of National Defence and the Canadian Armed Forces*.
- Freidson, E. (2001). *Professionalism: The Third Logic*. University of Chicago Press.

DID YOU KNOW?

NEARLY 30% OF CAF MEMBERS AGED 18-29 ARE CLASSIFIED AS OBESE, BEFORE REACHING THEIR OPERATIONAL PEAK THIS SILENT READINESS CRISIS IS ERODING THE FIGHTING EDGE FROM THE INSIDE OUT.

IT HIGHLIGHTS THE URGENT NEED TO PRIORITIZE HOLISTIC READINESS; ADDRESSING PHYSICAL FITNESS, MENTAL WELLBEING, AND LIFESTYLE HABITS, NOT JUST FOR INDIVIDUAL PERFORMANCE, BUT TO MEET INSTITUTIONAL EXPECTATIONS AS OUTLINED IN THE CAF FORCE POSTURE AND READINESS DIRECTIVE. ENSURING EVERY MEMBER IS TRULY FIT TO FIGHT IS ESSENTIAL TO MEETING THE DEMANDS OF OUR EVOLVING SECURITY ENVIRONMENT.

Sources:

[Statistics Canada \(2023\). The Health and Lifestyle Information Survey of Canadian Armed Forces Personnel, 2019](#)

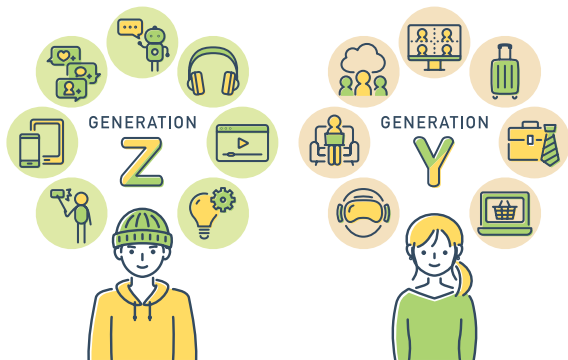
[Sleep duration, sleep quality and obesity in the Canadian Armed Forces CDS/DM Directive for CAF Force Posture and Readiness \(FP&R\) 2024/2025 - Canada.ca](#)



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THE STRENGTH OF GENERATIONS: EMBRACING DIVERSITY FOR A STRONGER CAF

In the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF), we stand united by a shared mission and core values, but we are, undeniably, a diverse group of individuals. Our workforce is made up of multiple generations, each bringing unique perspective. In the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF), we stand united by a shared mission and core values, but we are, undeniably, a diverse group of individuals. Our workforce is made up of multiple generations, each bringing unique perspectives, skills, and experiences to the table. As leaders, it is essential that we understand and embrace the advantages of this generational diversity while also acknowledging the challenges it presents. One approach to this reality, grounded in discipline, self-control, and acceptance, offers a path forward to fostering a cohesive and effective environment for all members.



The wisdom in generational diversity

As senior leaders, we know that we need to embrace challenges as opportunities for growth. In the context of the CAF, our diversity, spanning Baby Boomers, Gen X, Millennials, and Gen Z, offers a rich landscape of wisdom and innovation. Each generation contributes in its own way, and our success depends on our ability to leverage these differences for the greater good of our community.

The Elder Generation (Baby Boomers & Gen X – most of us): These individuals bring invaluable experience and wisdom forged through years of service. Their commitment to duty, resilience, and perseverance provides a steady foundation for the CAF. Yet, their long-standing experience may sometimes make it difficult to fully engage with newer methodologies or technological advancements. Here, we must practice our virtue of temperance, recognizing the need for adaptability without abandoning the tried-and-tested practices that have served us well.

The Younger Generation (Millennials & Gen Z): The younger generations bring fresh perspectives, technological fluency, and new approaches to problem-solving. Their ability to think outside the box and adapt to rapid changes in the world can significantly enhance our operational capabilities. However, they may also face challenges in fully understanding the depth of military traditions or navigating the structure of a hierarchy-based organization. For them, wisdom lies in patience, recognizing that mastery comes not just from innovation, but from understanding the principles and values that underpin the CAF.



Embracing the benefits of a diverse group

The integration of these diverse generational viewpoints creates a dynamic environment that can propel the CAF forward in an ever-changing world. By collaborating across age groups, we open the door to increased creativity, better decision-making, and more robust problem-solving. This diversity encourages innovation, as well as the preservation of time-tested practices that provide stability and continuity.

Mentorship and knowledge transfer is a requirement, and generational diversity is an opportunity for mentorship. Senior members can pass on their invaluable experiences, while younger members can teach their counterparts the digital skills and modern strategies that are becoming increasingly vital. A committed mentorship program ensures that the wisdom of one generation is passed on, while the vitality and energy of another are harnessed for the collective good.

Fostering a collaborative spirit: By actively promoting cross-generational collaboration, we break down barriers and foster mutual respect. When different generations work together, we see the blending of experience with fresh insight. This harmony can lead to more effective decision-making, better morale, and stronger bonds of camaraderie within the CAF.

Actionable steps you can implement as a Unit / Formation CWO

Encourage open dialogue: Create spaces where all members, regardless of their generation, feel heard and respected. Holding regular forums or meetings where individuals can share their experiences, ideas, and concerns fosters understanding and strengthens communication.

Promote lifelong learning: Offer educational programs that allow individuals from all generations to continue developing their skills. Continuous learning ensures the CAF remains adaptable in an ever-evolving world.

Leverage strengths through cross-generational teams: Involve people from various generations in teams that capitalize on everyone's strengths. For instance, pairing younger members with seasoned leaders on projects allows for the transfer of expertise and fosters an environment of mutual respect and growth.

Instill the virtue of patience: While collaboration may take time, especially when adjusting to different working styles or perspectives, the practice of patience reminds us that progress is a gradual process. Trust in the process and in one another's contributions, and we will ultimately strengthen our collective resolve. The reality of working with a multigenerational workforce can be complex, but it is also an extraordinary strength. When we approach it with CAF character traits, wisdom, courage, temperance, and justice, we unlock the full potential of a diverse group. By fostering understanding, encouraging mentorship, and actively working to build a culture of respect across generations, the CAF will be better positioned to face the challenges of tomorrow.



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RESILIENCE VS NEGATIVE THINKING

Ref A: [What is Resilience?](#)

B: [Frontiers | Understanding resilience](#)

C: [Facial Scar Discrimination Experiment | Konstantin Kisin](#)

Stress is a part of all aspects of life, whether it is acute or chronic. There will always be some form of distress or eustress associated with serving our country. How we adapt to these stressors will determine their impact on our bodies, both physically and mentally. This is why developing resilience is critically important. It allows us to transform negative stress into a positive experience, enabling us to better manage and control adverse situations.

References A and B define resilience as a “positive adaptation, or the ability to maintain or regain mental health, despite experiencing adversity,” or as “the capacity and dynamic process of adaptively overcoming stress and adversity while maintaining normal psychological and physical functioning.” Essentially, resilience helps shift our mindset during distressing situations, positively enhancing personal growth, which in turn improves team dynamics. It is therefore essential that we recognize the need to be more resilient in the face of adversity.

However, it is often said that we become products of our environment. Many external factors distort our way of thinking, including social media, ideological beliefs, politics, mainstream media, and societal norms. These influences often skew our thinking toward negativity. As a result, we create cognitive distortions—perceived realities that don’t actually exist. This negative thought pattern can lead to negative behaviours that affect how we interact within a team setting.

Furthermore, we tend to project our thoughts and perceptions onto others. For example, if you slip and fall, your immediate reaction may be to look around and see if anyone witnessed it. You might feel



embarrassed, foolish, or clumsy, and assume that others are thinking the same about you. In reality, they are likely more concerned with whether you’re hurt rather than judging you. We must be mindful not to project our internal dialogue onto others, and instead trust that our fire team partners are there to support us when we stumble.

Resilience enables us to transform adverse situations into positive outcomes. This shift in perspective changes how we think and ultimately influences our behaviour in a constructive manner. Such transformation is especially valuable in a team environment. Avoiding hardship or adversity weakens our resilience, leading to a diminished ability to cope with stress. This, in turn, can negatively affect both our mental and physical health.

Embracing life’s stressors strengthens our resilience. It enhances the mind, body, and spirit—all of which contribute to readiness and the ability to meet the operational demands of the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF).





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THE WARFIGHTING COMMAND SENIOR ENLISTED LEADER

24 February 2025 marked the three-year anniversary of the Russian invasion of Ukraine. Since then, the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) has significantly amended its plans, force structure, and posture to ensure readiness to defend every inch of the Alliance. Consequently, NATO has had to rapidly evolve from a crisis management model to a full warfighting concept. The NATO Warfighting Capstone Concept (NWCC) focuses on ensuring that NATO forces remain capable, adaptable, and technologically advanced in an era of strategic competition with adversaries such as Russia.

The key objectives of the NWCC are; integrated multi-domain defence, layered resilience, influence and power projection, cross-domain command, and cognitive superiority. Moreover, NATO emphasizes the importance of being capable of “Fighting Tonight”, the ability to immediately respond to threats and crises with highly ready and rapidly deployable forces. To enable this evolution, NATO is now requiring leaders at all levels to adopt and promote a warfighting culture, in which the Command Senior Enlisted Leader (CSEL) plays a vital role.

Currently, the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF) has five Chief Warrant Officers (CWOs) serving in CSEL positions within the NATO Command Structure (NCS): Multi-National Corps North-East (MNC-NE), Multi-National Corps South-East (MNC-SE), Allied Land Command (LANDCOM), Allied Joint Force Command Brunssum (JFCBS), and Allied Command Operations (ACO). These CSELs work directly alongside three- or four-star generals commanding formations and leading multi-domain operations.

In comparison to the CAF, the role and responsibilities of a CSEL are very similar to those of a typical Command Chief Warrant Officer

(CWO) or Chief Petty Officer First Class (CPO1). The CSEL is expected to provide advice on matters affecting personnel and to offer valuable feedback that can influence the commander’s decision-making cycle. Additionally, the CSEL ensures compliance with policies, adherence to standards, performance and conduct, effective training, and the maintenance of discipline within their command. Importantly, the CSEL is also responsible for communicating and translating the commander’s direction and guidance to staff and subordinates.

Notably, the CSEL functions as an institutional leader whose responsibilities extend beyond their headquarters, applying equally to subordinate formations and operational environments. However, these roles and responsibilities were defined during peacetime. Given NATO’s evolution toward a warfighting concept, it is appropriate to ask: would the CSEL’s current functions remain relevant in a crisis or conflict? If not, what adjustments would be required?

Although NATO is not currently engaged in large-scale conflict, it is difficult to definitively answer this question or dismiss the value of the current CSEL framework. In fact, many of the existing CSEL roles are likely still applicable in wartime. That said, the transition to a warfighting-focused CSEL would likely demand increased attention to specific areas not emphasized in peacetime. One such area is force readiness.

Force readiness is fundamental to warfighting, as commanders require accurate assessments of their units’ combat capabilities. Unfortunately, operational plans are sometimes disconnected from on-the-ground realities, particularly in terms of personnel and equipment readiness. To bridge this gap, the warfighting CSEL, leveraging their established networks, can verify the ground truth, identify friction points, and assess what resources are truly available in the “ready rack.” Even more critically, the CSEL can report on troop morale and their willingness to fight.

Another key area of focus for the warfighting CSEL is operational planning and execution across multiple domains. While most CSELs are tactical experts based on their experience, they must evolve to remain relevant and credible at the operational level. This requires active involvement in the operational planning process to ensure that tactical-level considerations are not overlooked.

It is also important to note that NATO’s operational level is far more complex than that of the CAF. NATO operations span multiple domains; land, air, maritime, cyber, and space, and involve multinational forces operating across national boundaries. These operations include multiple layers of complexity, such as the political dynamics of individual member nations and their influence on Alliance decision-making. Navigating this complexity is where the warfighting CSEL must be able to operate effectively, constantly adapting to the evolving operating environment.

FUTURE NOTABLE DATES

- 11 Sep – Pan CAF PAB1/ PMB1 Ottawa, On
- 15 Sep – 24 Oct – National Selection Boards, Ottawa, On
- 6-9 Oct – OP NAWAPON (CAFCWO), St-Jean sur Richelieu, Qc.
- 10 Nov – CAFCWO Sentry Dinner Ottawa, On
- Dec – Pan CAF PAB2/ PMB2 Ottawa, On



COLLABORATION

- SJS CWO – CWO Bouchard Sandra
- CPCC CCWO – CWO Lavoie Frederik
- Digital Services Group CWO – CWO Pickard Jason
- CSEL JFC Brunssum – CWO Thomassin Christian



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CAF Operation Summary // CAN UNCLASSIFIED



Operation		Location	Description
N1	LIMPID	High Artic	Canada's continued commitment to maintain domain awareness and exercise sovreignty in the North
N2	NANOOK	Northern Canada	CAF exercising the defence and security of Canada's Northern Region.
A1	CROCODILE	Congo	Staff officers and training support to UN operations in the DRC
A2	SOPRANO	South Sudan	Staff officers and military liaison supporting cease-hostilities agreement
M1	CALUMET	Egypt	Provision of critical mission support to independent peacekeeping operation between Egypt & Israel
M2	FOUNDATION	Qatar/Tampa/Bahrain/UAE	Staff officers, specialist support, and liaison to US counter-terrorism operations
M3	ARMANA	Middle East	CAF support to Capacity Building in the Middle East.
M4	JADE	Israel / Lebanon	United Nations Truce Supervision Organization mission to observe and supervise regional cease-fire between Israel, Egypt, Jordan, Lebanon and Syria and to implement the Armistice Agreements
M5	PROTEUS	Israel	Provision of training and advice to improve capacity of Palestinian Authority Security Forces
P1	HORIZON	South China Sea	Conduct presence operations in support of DND/CAF and GoC objectives
P2	NEON	Asia Pacific Ocean	Conduct surveillance operations to detect, deter and disrupt illicit ship-to-ship transfers to dissuade DPRK's weapons of mass destruction program
E1	KOBOLD	Kosovo	CAF contribution to NATO-led KFOR to maintain a safe and secure environment in Kosovo
E2	SNOWGOOSE	Cyprus	UN mission to monitor political developments affecting the status quo in Cyprus
E3	REASSURANCE	Latvia / UK / Baltic Sea / Mediter-ranean	NATO deterrence and defence measures in Central and Eastern Europe
E4	UNIFIER	Germany / Poland / UK / Latvia	Military training, professionalization, and capacity building mission in support of Ukraine.

